

crafting a question and argument

1. probability: state hypotheses a priori most likely to be falsified
2. evolution: competition between hypotheses
3. hermeneutics: repeatable tests (experiments) with clear criteria

science

how something *is*

repeatable by others

conclusion applies universally

explicit impact of results

evaluate a specific criterion
(hypothesis test)

design

how something *may be*

unique conditions

“one-shot”

result “inspires” other cases

evaluate from any possible
angle (criticism)

It is actually a question. It can be, and usually is, stated as a question.

It is not a “straw man”.

It is genuinely unknown. Not an assumption, not “begged”.

It can be answered by evidence to follow (ideally with either outcome).

It can be associated with a clear criterion (“inter-subjective”, means of measurement, etc.).

1. introduction

- identifies gap in existing knowledge (references required to understand the question)
- state the question defined by this gap
- (hypothesis, and means of determining it)

this can be answered by a specific empirical observation. state it.

defines the scope of the paper.

2. literature review

- knowledge required to understand the rest
- previous work re-presented only as relevant to the research question

3. method

4. results

*the main substance of the work
this provides all the evidence needed to answer the question*

5. conclusion

- the answer to the question

precisely mirrors question at the start.

1. introduction

- identifies gap in existing knowledge (references required to understand the question)
- state the question defined by this gap
- (hypothesis, and means of determining it)

ideal basis for coursework: this comes from your debate

2. literature review

- knowledge required to understand the rest
- previous work re-presented only as relevant to the research question

can you make it a scientific/emperical investigation with a (scientifically valid) question?

3. method

4. results

5. conclusion

- the answer to the question